

Curriculum Vitae — Sandro Lüscher

✉ luescher@zda.uzh.ch |  [0000-0002-6092-5422](https://orcid.org/0000-0002-6092-5422) |  Centre for Democracy Studies Aarau

SUMMARY

Postdoctoral researcher at the Centre for Democracy Studies Aarau (ZDA), University of Zurich. My research focuses on political institutions, electoral systems, and public governance, with particular attention to consultation procedures and pre-legislative decision-making.

My doctoral dissertation examined the adoption and political effects of the divisor-based biproportional apportionment method in Swiss cantons, combining comparative case studies with quantitative causal inference. Current work analyses stakeholder consultation and decentralized decision-making, including DAO-inspired governance applied to Swiss digital identity reforms and democratic innovation.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Postdoc, Research Associate

Jan 2025 – present

[Centre for Democracy Studies Aarau \(ZDA\), University of Zurich](#)

Research on digital democracy and participatory governance in the project *Decentralized Decision-Making in DAOs: Learnings for Digital Democracy*.

Assistant and Doctoral Candidate

Jul 2019 – Sep 2024

[Department of Political Science \(IPZ\), University of Zurich](#)

Assistant at the Chair of Policy Analysis and Evaluation; teaching assistance in the seminar *Decision-making processes in Swiss politics*.

Student Research Assistant

Jan 2019 – May 2019

[School of Economics and Political Science \(SEPS\), University of St. Gallen](#)

Student research assistant in the project *Municipality-Level Outcomes of Direct-Democratic Votes in Switzerland, 1866–2023*.

Student Research Assistant

Sep 2015 – Dec 2015

[Department of Political Science \(IPZ\), University of Zurich](#)

Research assistant in the project *Years of Turmoil: The Political Consequences of the Financial and Economic Crisis in Europe*.

CURRENT PROJECTS

FOKUS Aargau — Post-vote surveys on cantonal elections and referendums

[Centre for Democracy Studies Aarau \(ZDA\), ongoing](#)

[Latest report](#)

Post-referendum and post-election surveys in the Canton of Aargau to explain voting behaviour; questionnaire design, analysis, reporting, and publication.

Decentralized Decision-Making in DAOs: Learnings for Digital Democracy

[SNSF Project, 2024–2027](#)

[SNSF grant 10000911](#)

Political-science contribution on decision-making: analysis of DAO voting and smart-contract rules as democratic procedures; dataset construction; evaluation of programmable aggregation using causal inference, agent-based simulation, and network methods; application to Swiss pre-legislative consultation procedures.

EDUCATION

- 2019–2024 PhD / Dr. phil., Political Science, University of Zurich.
- 2017–2019 MA Social Sciences (Political Science & Modern History), University of Zurich; Diploma Supplement (track in Swiss Politics).
- 2013–2016 BA Social Sciences (Political Science & Modern History), University of Zurich.
- 2007–2012 Swiss Matura (track in Philosophy, Psychology and Pedagogy), Public Academic High School of Baden.

PUBLICATIONS

- Lüscher, S., & Serdült, U. (2026). DAO Decision-Making Simulation for Legislative Consultation: The Case of the Swiss E-ID Law 2019. *Proceedings of the 59th Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences (HICSS)*, 2310–2319. [hdl:10125/111673](https://hdl.handle.net/10125/111673)
- Bernhard, L., Cheon, J., Lüscher, S., & Serdült, U. (2026). *Studie zur kantonalen Volksabstimmung vom 8. März 2026 (FOKUS Aargau)*. Zentrum für Demokratie Aarau (ZDA). [Report](#)
- Bernhard, L., Cheon, J., Lüscher, S., Koelewijn, K. S., Sorrentino, G., & Serdült, U. (2025). *FOKUS Aargau: Studie zu den Aargauer Volksabstimmungen vom 18. Mai 2025*. Zentrum für Demokratie Aarau (ZDA). [doi:10.5167/UZH-278944](https://doi.org/10.5167/UZH-278944)
- Lüscher, S. (2024). *Redeeming the Pledge of Electoral Equity? A Study of the Roads to and Effects of the Divisor-Based Biproportional Apportionment Method in Switzerland*. PhD dissertation, University of Zurich. [doi:10.5167/UZH-264856](https://doi.org/10.5167/UZH-264856)
- Lüscher, S. (2023). Parlamentswahlen nach dem doppelt-proportionalen Sitzzuteilungsverfahren im Lichte der territorialen Repräsentation. *Zeitschrift für Parlamentsfragen*, 54(3), 571–595. [doi:10.5771/0340-1758-2023-3-571](https://doi.org/10.5771/0340-1758-2023-3-571)
- Lüscher, S. (2021). Proportionality in Two Dimensions: Resolving an Old Dilemma of Political (Mis)representation. In *Swiss Political Science Association Annual Congress 2021*. [doi:10.5167/UZH-206811](https://doi.org/10.5167/UZH-206811)

FORTHCOMING WORK

- Lüscher, S., Serdült, U., & Walla, A. (2026). Can Consultation Be a DAO? Co-Creation and Conflict Restructuring in Swiss E-ID Reforms. Forthcoming in the Springer proceedings of the European DAO Workshop 2026 (DAWO26).
- Hofmann, G., & Lüscher, S. (2026). Vom historischen Schutzinstrument zum demokratischen Hemmschuh? Das Ständemehr im 21. Jahrhundert. Manuscript under peer review for the *Schriftenreihe der Neuen Helvetischen Gesellschaft Schweiz*.
- Lüscher, S. *Mechanisms of Stakeholder Consultation: Explaining Symbolic and Substantive Outcomes in Policymaking*. Manuscript in finalization.
- Gharbi, H., Badertscher, C., Lüscher, S., & Serdült, U. *Toward Blockchain-Based Election Campaign Vouchers*. Work in progress.
- Lüscher, S. *When Reason Bows to Emotion: Affective Polarization and Cognitive Bias in Party Evaluation*. Work in progress.
- Lüscher, S. *Marginal Votes under Biproportionality: The Local Costs of Global Proportionality*. Invited contribution for a special issue. Work in progress.
- Lüscher, S., Cheon, J., Bernhard, L., & Serdült, U. *Who Benefits from Citizen-Directed Funding? Democracy Vouchers and Party Competition in a Multiparty Context*. Work in progress.

WORKSHOPS & CONFERENCES

- 2026 ECPR General Conference, Jagiellonian University, Krakow. Paper presentation.
- 2026 European DAO Workshop (DAWO26), ZHAW. Paper presentation.
- 2026 Workshop “Polarized Democracies”, MIDEM, TU Dresden. Paper presentation; travel and lodging grant.
- 2026 Conference on Policy Process Research (COPPR), University of Bern. Participation.
- 2026 Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences (HICSS-59), Maui. Paper presentation by co-author.
- 2025 European DAO Workshop (DAWO25), ZHAW. Participation.
- 2021 SVPW-ASSP Annual Conference, University of Bern. Paper presentation.
- 2020 ECPR Virtual General Conference. Participation.
- 2020 SVPW-ASSP Annual Conference, University of Lucerne. Participation.

MEDIA COVERAGE

- Wer profitiert von einer Einführung von Demokratiegutscheinen? *DeFacto*. 29 January 2026.
 - E-Collecting in der Schweiz: Akzeptanz und Reformbedarf nach dem Unterschriftenbetrug *DeFacto*. 22 August 2025.
 - Breite Zustimmung der Bevölkerung für eine elektronische Unterschriftensammlung bei Initiativen *NZZ am Sonntag*. 9 August 2025.
 - 20 Jahre Doppelproporz – eine Rückschau *DeFacto*. 20 February 2025.
 - Warum Schweden die bessere Demokratie ist *Beobachter*. 2 December 2022.
 - The Different Faces of Direct Democracy *Swissinfo*. 16 March 2018.
- Complete list available at luescher-s.github.io/media.html.

SKILLS

- Methods Causal inference; statistical analysis (large N); data visualization; simulation.
- Software MS Office; R; Python; Git; APES; L^AT_EX; HTML.
- Languages German (native); English (fluent); French (intermediate); Italian (basic).

MEMBERSHIPS

- Digital Society Initiative of the University of Zurich
- European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR)
- Board Member, New Helvetic Society Aargau (Switzerland’s oldest civic society)